Unit 4 Assignment

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Remote Staff Initiative

Unplanned Event

Due to unforeseen events, Ms. Perfect will be unavailable for the remainder of the remote staff initiative. While she was able to complete the testing of the mobile device management functionalities, many components were not yet tested before her leave. With that said, Ms. Perfect developed a list of functions that needed to be verified within each component to ensure the pre-defined criteria was met. This documentation is critical as it allows the organization to find another candidate to fill Ms. Perfect's role in the project.

This unplanned event was selected to demonstrate the importance of not only finding the right staff members to complete project tasks, but also the right staff to replace team members if necessary. The loss of a project team member can result in disruptions to workflow, communication, schedules, and expenses. For the remote staff initiative, the loss of Ms. Perfect could result in incomplete testing of the software, hardware, or network setups. If this were to occur, the remote staff may be improperly setup for the transition which would impact both staff productivity and the customer experience. Another potential impact for this issue is that the project may be delayed if a new team member is not immediately available to take over the remaining tasks of the testing milestone. The proposed solution for this dilemma would be to have Mr. Lyst fill in for the remaining duration of the project. This solution utilizes a team member who is not only familiar with the project, but who was also responsible for assisted with determining the requirements for staff to transition to work remotely. This advantage will allow the organization to remain on schedule and ensure quality is maintained. Another advantage of this adaptation is that Mr. Lyst's hourly wage is less than that of Ms. Perfect's which will

actually result in a decrease of expenses rather than the potential increase it may cost to bring in a new quality assurance engineer.

Meeting Recap

Meeting minutes			
Meeting Date	3/9/21	**Next Meeting Date**	3/16/21
Attendees	Ms. Ainslie Mr. Micro Mrs. Wan Mr. Fixit Mr. Lyst		
Agenda	• Staff change. • Hardware discoveries • Routers installed • Budget changes		
Details			
Items	**Description**		**Presented by**
Item 1	Ms. Perfect is no longer available and Mr. Lyst will be filling the role as quality assurance engineer.		Ms. Ainslie
Item 2	Computers had varying updates needs. Audit should be conducted on the in-office devices once the project is concluded.		Mr. Fixit
Item 3	A total of 43 routers were installed. A total of 20 hotspots were installed.		Mr. Fixit
Item 4	The original expense estimate was $71,934 and did not include hotspot procurement. The current expenditures thus far total $30,412.00. The refined projected cumulative cost is $58,549.00.		Ms. Ainslie
Next Steps			
Item Due Date	**Action**		**Responsible Party**
3/12/21	Test routers and hotspots to ensure they meet or exceed connectivity criteria.		Mr. Lyst

Table 1. This table provides the details of the recent remote staff initiative project meeting.

Status Report

Status Report			
Tasks Completed	**Milestone**	**Accomplishments**	**Lessons Learned**
Install web cams	Prepare Hardware	All 200 webcams were installed. Roughly 60 computers required both audio and video driver updates while another 20 required either the audio or video driver be updated.	Audio and video drivers on many computers were not up to date for the new web cams. There were also a number of devices that required general system updates. An audit should be done on the remaining staff computers after the project's conclusion to ensure all devices in office are up to date.
Setup Routers	Prepare Network	43 routers were installed in remote staff networks.	N/A
Setup Hotspots	Prepare Network	20 hotspots were installed in remote staff networks.	N/A
Resource Accessibility	Testing	Confirmed all 200 remote staff members can access company resources from remote networks.	N/A
Connectivity	Testing	Confirmed VPN allows for a steady connection to company resources.	N/A
Test Access Controls	Testing	Confirmed remote staff members have the appropriate access levels to perform daily objectives.	In the event other departments begin to work remotely, new access roles will need to be developed. This may also require additional VPN be setup for added security.
Test Webcams	Testing	Confirmed all 200 webcams are compatible with existing Amazon Chime software.	N/A

Table 2. This table provides an inside look on the current status of the remote support initiative.

Expenses

Cumulative Cost	Actual Cost	Remaining Cost	Resource Names	% Complete
$1,120.00	$1,120.00	$0.00	Mr. Lyst	100%
$800.00	$800.00	$0.00	Ms. Ainslie	100%
$15,792.00	$15,792.00	$0.00	Web Cams[200], Mr. Fixit	100%
$21,000.00	$3,400.00	$17,600.00	VPN[200], MDM[200], Mr. Micro	99%
$14,189.00	$5,892.00	$8,297.00	Cat5[60],Routers[43], Mrs. Wan, Hotspots[20]	99%
$4,528.00	$3,408.00	$1,120.00	Ms. Perfect, Mr. Lyst	75%
$1,120.00	$0.00	$1,120.00	Ms. Ainslie	0%

Table 3. This table provides a breakdown of expenses to date, resources, and percentage of work completed, all of which are broken down by milestone.

WBS updates

ID	Task Mode	Task Name	Duration	Start	Finish	Predecessors	Resource Names	Milestone	Cost	% Work Co
1		**Analysis**	**4 days**	**Wed 2/3/21**	**Wed 2/3/21**	**4**	**Mr. Lyst**	**No**	**$1,120.00**	
2		Analyze Hardware	2 days	Wed 2/3/21	Thu 2/4/21		Mr. Lyst	No	$560.00	
3		Analyze Software	2 days	Fri 2/5/21	Mon 2/8/21		Mr. Lyst	No	$560.00	
4		**AUP**	**5 days**	**Tue 2/9/21**	**Tue 2/9/21**	**7**	**Ms. Ainslie**	**No**	**$800.00**	
5		Create Contracts	2 days	Tue 2/9/21	Wed 2/10/21		Ms. Ainslie	No	$320.00	
6		Contracts Signed	3 days	Thu 2/11/21	Mon 2/15/21		Ms. Ainslie	No	$480.00	
7		**Prepare Hardware**	**14 days**	**Tue 2/16/21**	**Tue 2/16/21**	**10**	**Web Cams[200],Mr. Fixit**	**No**	**$15,792.00**	
8		Update Computers	7 days	Tue 2/16/21	Wed 2/24/21		Mr. Fixit	No	$896.00	
9		Install web cams	7 days	Thu 2/25/21	Fri 3/5/21		Mr. Fixit	No	$896.00	
10		**Prepare Software**	**0 days**	**Tue 2/16/21**	**Tue 2/16/21**	**13**	**VPN[200],MDM[200],Mr. I**	**Yes**	**$21,000.00**	
11		Install MDM	5 days	Tue 2/16/21	Mon 2/22/21		Mr. Micro	No	$1,680.00	
12		Install VPN	5 days	Tue 2/23/21	Mon 3/1/21		Mr. Micro	No	$1,680.00	
13		**Prepare Network**	**0 days**	**Tue 2/16/21**	**Tue 2/16/21**		**Cat5[60],Routers[43],Mrs.**	**Yes**	**$14,189.00**	
14		**Network Check**	**5 days**	**Tue 2/16/21**	**Mon 2/22/21**		**Mrs. Wan**	**No**	**$1,640.00**	
15		Bandwidth	5 days	Tue 2/16/21	Mon 2/22/21			No	$0.00	
16		Latency	5 days	Tue 2/16/21	Mon 2/22/21			No	$0.00	
17		Packet loss	5 days	Tue 2/16/21	Mon 2/22/21			No	$0.00	
18		**Configuration**	**9 days**	**Tue 2/23/21**	**Fri 3/5/21**	**14**	**Mrs. Wan**	**No**	**$2,952.00**	
19		Enable Multicast	5 days	Tue 2/23/21	Mon 3/1/21			No	$0.00	
20		Confirm No Double Nat	5 days	Tue 2/23/21	Mon 3/1/21			No	$0.00	
21		Firewall Rules	5 days	Tue 2/23/21	Mon 3/1/21			No	$0.00	
22		Disable SIP ALG	5 days	Tue 2/23/21	Mon 3/1/21			No	$0.00	
23		**Install New Routers**	**9 days**	**Tue 2/23/21**	**Fri 3/5/21**			**No**	**$0.00**	
24		Setup Routers	7 days	Tue 2/23/21	Wed 3/3/21			No	$0.00	
25		Setup Hotspots	2 days	Thu 3/4/21	Fri 3/5/21			No	$0.00	

Figure 1. This image shows the first portion of the updated WBS.

ID	Task Mode	Task Name	Duration	Start	Finish	Predecessors	Resource Names	Milestone	Cost	% Work Co
20		Confirm No Double Nat	5 days	Tue 2/23/21	Mon 3/1/21			No	$0.00	
21		Firewall Rules	5 days	Tue 2/23/21	Mon 3/1/21			No	$0.00	
22		Disable SIP ALG	5 days	Tue 2/23/21	Mon 3/1/21			No	$0.00	
23		**Install New Routers**	**9 days**	**Tue 2/23/21**	**Fri 3/5/21**			**No**	**$0.00**	
24		Setup Routers	7 days	Tue 2/23/21	Wed 3/3/21			No	$0.00	
25		Setup Hotspots	2 days	Thu 3/4/21	Fri 3/5/21			No	$0.00	
26		**Testing**	**0 days?**	**Mon 2/22/21**	**Mon 2/22/21**		**Ms. Perfect,Mr. Lyst**	**Yes**	**$4,528.00**	
27		**Test MDM**	**2 days**	**Tue 2/23/21**	**Wed 2/24/21**	**11**		**No**	**$1,152.00**	
28		Test Alerts	2 days	Tue 2/23/21	Wed 2/24/21		Ms. Perfect	No	$576.00	
29		Test compromising MDM	2 days	Tue 2/23/21	Wed 2/24/21		Ms. Perfect	No	$576.00	
30		**Test VPN**	**2 days?**	**Tue 3/2/21**	**Wed 3/3/21**	**12**		**No**	**$2,256.00**	
31		Resource Accessibility	2 days	Tue 3/2/21	Wed 3/3/21		Ms. Perfect	No	$576.00	
32		<New Task>						No	$0.00	
33		Connectivity	2 days	Wed 3/3/21	Thu 3/4/21		Mr. Lyst	No	$560.00	
34		Test Access Controls	2 days	Fri 3/5/21	Mon 3/8/21		Mr. Lyst	No	$560.00	
35		Test Webcams	2 days	Mon 3/8/21	Tue 3/9/21	9	Mr. Lyst	No	$560.00	
36		**Test Connectivity**	**4 days**	**Tue 3/9/21**	**Fri 3/12/21**	**34**	**Mr. Lyst**	**No**	**$1,120.00**	
37		Test Hotspots	2 days	Tue 3/9/21	Wed 3/10/21			No	$0.00	
38		Test Routers	2 days	Thu 3/11/21	Fri 3/12/21			No	$0.00	
39		**Assessments**	**0 days**	**Mon 3/15/21**	**Mon 3/15/21**	**26**	**Ms. Ainslie**	**Yes**	**$1,120.00**	
40		QA Review	1 day	Mon 3/15/21	Mon 3/15/21		Ms. Ainslie	No	$160.00	
41		Stakeholder Notice	1 day	Tue 3/16/21	Tue 3/16/21		Ms. Ainslie	No	$320.00	
42		Final Status	1 day	Wed 3/17/21	Wed 3/17/21	41	Ms. Ainslie	No	$320.00	
43		Lessons Learned	1 day	Thu 3/18/21	Thu 3/18/21	42	Ms. Ainslie	No	$320.00	

Figure 2. This image shows the second portion of the updated WBS.

Potential Issues

Telework is not a new concept; however, it can be challenging to implement. In addition to the operational concerns, organizations must understand the potential risks associated with allowing employees to work remotely. These challenges can vary depending on the purpose of the organization, the geographical location, or other factors. This paper will attempt to divulge the biggest ethical and legal problems faced when allowing employees to work remotely.

Ethical Versus Legal

Before exploring the ethical and legal issues of remote work it is vital to recognize the differences between these two terms. This is important to understand as an ethical concern can be a legal concern; yet, legal concerns do not always involve ethics. Legal issues are caused by an individual, or an organization, performing an action that is against written rules created by a form of judicial system (Tzafestas, 2018). Ethical issues on the other hand are actions which are frowned upon by society, but may not result in litigation (Tzafestas, 2018). Since some matters can be both ethical and legal issues the following sections will break down the concerns of remote work into two sub-topics: Privacy and dishonesty.

Privacy

Remote work can be challenging for some company owners due to the loss of visibility.

It may lead to questions such as how one can ensure that employees are working when they should be or that they are following company guidelines. The simple answer would be to trust employees; however, management is not a simple subject. There are many options for monitoring or controlling staff, but it is important to consider what the implications of these tools may be. For instance, webcams intended for meetings could be used to keep a watchful eye on staff members to see that they are actually working. Even if this is written into some form of contractual agreement this may lead to ethical or even legal issues depending on how the footage is used. If an embarrassing image is captured from the footage and shared among peers this would be unethical; however, it may only become a legal issue if the image were shared publicly.

Monitoring software is another option for organizations who are concerned about the performance of remote staff members. Unfortunately, such tools often log all minuscule actions performed on a computer which could result in the inappropriate collection of sensitive data from both the employee and the customers (Smith, 2021). This becomes an ethical issue when employees are permitted to use the work computer for personal tasks during their breaks such as checking their email, paying bills, or logging into their bank account. If the monitoring software is logging these actions the employer will then have access to passwords and other personal information that the employee may not realize is being stored in a company database (Smith, 2021).

Dishonesty

Regrettably, there are also ethical and legal concerns surrounding remote staff members not being monitored. Causes for concern include staff members cutting corners to produce results faster, failing to notify employers of incidents, not committing to quality, misinforming clients, committing time theft, or stealing and selling intellectual property (Roomy, 2020). Remote staff

members may feel stressed and perform unethical actions or they may simply feel less anxious about performing actions they believe they can get away with (Roomy, 2020). Unfortunately, these are risks that the organization must consider before implementing a remote staff program to protect themselves and their customers. While cutting corners to produce results may be unethical, it can quickly turn into a legal battle should the work be of poor quality and dissatisfy a client. Additional legal issues may rise from remote staff misinforming clients or not informing employers of a compliance violation.

Summary

Allowing employees to work remotely is not something that should be taken lightly. Organizations can face both legal and ethical dilemmas that may be intensified when employees are unmonitored, or are simply not in a room of their peers. Factors that must be taken in account are if and how staff will be monitored, how will employees privacy be protected, and how will the organization and clients be protected. Failing to properly prepare for the risks of remote work has the potential to negatively impact an organizations reputation as well as cause legal or financial burdens. This is not to say organizations should avoid allowing staff to work remotely, but rather to educate organizations that there are many scenarios and factors that need to be considered prior to implementation.

References

Khan, R. (2020). Work from anywhere trend intensifying ethics, and compliance issues. Retrieved from https://www.forbes.com/sites/roomykhan/2020/11/06/work-from-anywhere-trend-intensifying-ethics-and-compliance-issues/?sh=49ffe3882f38

Smith, E. (2021). Four ethical considerations for using employee monitoring software on remote workers. Retrieved from https://associationsnow.com/2021/03/four-ethical-considerations-for-using-employee-monitoring-software-on-remote-workers/

Tzafestas, S. G. (2018). Ethics and Law in the Internet of Things World. *Smart Cities*, *1* (1), 98-120. https://doi.org/10.3390/smartcities1010006